



Continuum Damage Mechanics

Course: Composite Material Damage Mechanics

Presenter: Rouzbeh Pourjafarian

Instructor: Dr. Hosseini Kordkheili

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General Concept

1 Introduction

- **Limitation of classical continuum mechanics:** Microdefects (grains, dislocations) are heterogeneous, but damaging processes involve strain localization and irreversibility.
- **Origin:** Kachanov (1958) and Rabotnov (1969) on metal creep → macroscopic damage variables.
- **Framework:** Thermodynamics of irreversible processes; complements Fracture Mechanics.
- **Goal:** Review some general features of C.D.M. and to summarize its main possibilities and introduce the possibility of describing the coupling effects between damage processes and the stress-strain behavior of materials.



General Concept

1 Introduction

- **Key aspects:**
 1. Definitions and measures of damage (mechanical variables for microstructure).
 2. Mechanical behavior of damaged material (includes anisotropy).
 3. Evolution equations for damage variables.



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2 Damage Measures and Definitions

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2.1. The Problem of Crack Initiation

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Damage Variable:** Not directly measurable; requires indirect procedures & corresponding models.
- **Crack Initiation (Jeal, 1985):** “Breaking up” of the continuum volume element.
 - Arbitrary in fatigue due to complex microstructural interactions.
- **Fracture Mechanics Requirement:** Macroscopic crack must span several grains for homogeneity (size, geometry, direction; Fig. 1).



2.1. The Problem of Crack Initiation

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

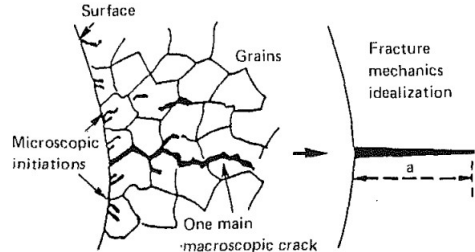
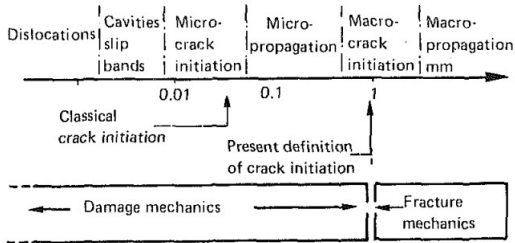


Fig. 1: (a) Schematics of the fatigue crack growth; (b) illustration of a macroscopic crack initiation concept.



2.2. The Remaining Life

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Engineering Definition (Manson, 1979; Chaboche, 1974):** Damage measured via remaining life.
- **Miner's Linear Rule:**

$$\frac{N_2}{N_{F_2}} = 1 - D = 1 - \frac{N_1}{N_{F_1}} \quad (2)$$

- **Key Observation (Krempel, 1977):** Damage evolution is not unique; depends on loading level (unseparability; Fig. 2).
- **Limitation:** Remaining life does not uniquely determine D (one-to-one mapping ambiguity).
- **Applicability:** Valid for both fatigue and creep.



2.2. The Remaining Life

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

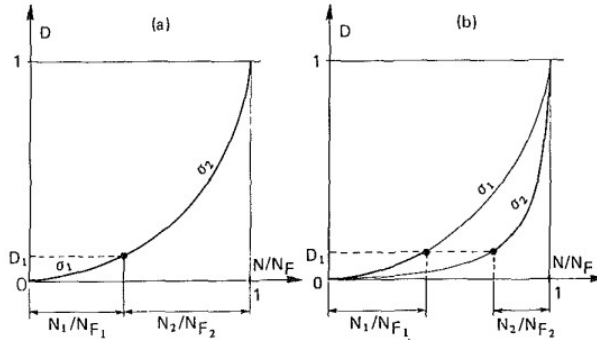


Fig. 2: Schematic of damage evolution curves as deduced from remaining life measures



2.3. The Microstructure

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Definition Basis (Dyson and McLean, 1977; Levaillant and Pineau, 1982):** Direct observation of defects and quantify the irreversible defects.
- **Limitations:**
 - Destructive measurement,
 - early-stage damage hard to observe,
 - Requires mapping to macroscopic variables for structural analysis.
- **Net Area Reduction (Scalar):**

$$D_n = \frac{S_D}{S} = \frac{S - S^*}{S} \quad (0 \leq D_n \leq D_c) \quad (3)$$

- S : total area, S^* : effective area
- **Critical Value:** $0.2 < D_c < 0.8$ for metals (Fig. 3).



2.3. The Microstructure

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

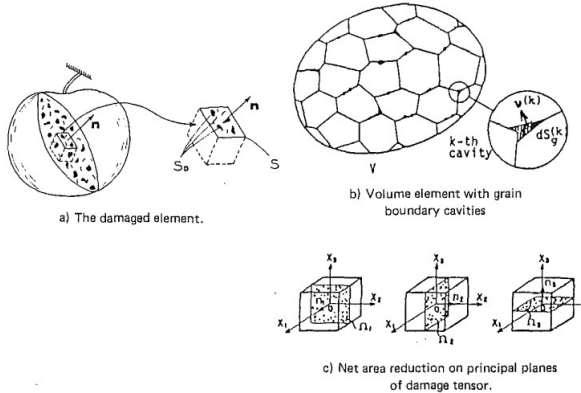


Fig. 3: Net area reduction: (a) The damaged element; (b) volume element with grain boundary cavities; (c) net area reduction on principal planes of damage tensor



2.3. The Microstructure

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Net Stress Concept (Murakami & Ohno, 1980):** For creep damage in polycrystalline metals, cavities on grain boundaries reduce the effective load-bearing area.
 - Damage state described by a **second-rank symmetric tensor** Ω (Murakami, 1983):

$$\Omega = \frac{3}{S_g(V)} \sum_{k=1}^N \int_V \vec{v}^{(k)} \otimes \vec{v}^{(k)} dS_g^{(k)} \quad (4)$$

where $dS_g^{(k)}$ = area of boundary occupied by k -th cavity, $\vec{v}^{(k)}$ = unit normal vector.

- The net stress σ^* is defined by assuming equivalence between damaged and undamaged material (Fig. 4).
- **Anisotropic Damage:**
 - The tensor definition naturally accounts for directional effects.
 - Alternative approach (Krajcinovic, 1983): family of vectors, each associated with a typical microcrack direction (similar to slip theory of plasticity).



2.3. The Microstructure

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

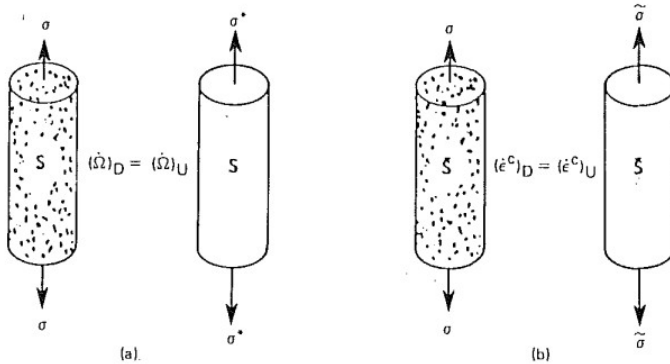


Fig. 4: (a) Net stress tensor for damage growth; (b) effective stress tensor



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Physical quantities affected by damage:**
 - Density change (Jonas & Baudalet, 1977) – ductile failure,
 - Resistivity change (Cailletaud et al., 1980) – similar to mechanical measures,
 - Acoustic emission, sound velocity,
 - fatigue limit change (Bui-Quoc et al., 1971) – related to remaining life.
- **Effective stress concept (Chaboche, 1974):**

$$\bar{\sigma} = \sigma \frac{S}{\bar{S}} = \frac{\sigma}{1 - D} \quad (5)$$

- with homogenization support (Duvaut, 1976).



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Ductile rupture (Lemaitre, 1985):** Measure elastic modulus change.

$$\sigma = \tilde{E} \epsilon_e, \quad \bar{\sigma} = E \epsilon_e \Rightarrow D = 1 - \frac{\tilde{E}}{E} \quad (6)$$

- **Brittle creep damage (Lemaitre & Chaboche, 1978):** Secondary creep power law (Fig. 5(a)):

$$\dot{\epsilon}_s = \left(\frac{\sigma}{\lambda} \right)^N \Rightarrow D = 1 - \left(\frac{\dot{\epsilon}}{\dot{\epsilon}_s} \right)^{1/N} \quad (7,8)$$



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

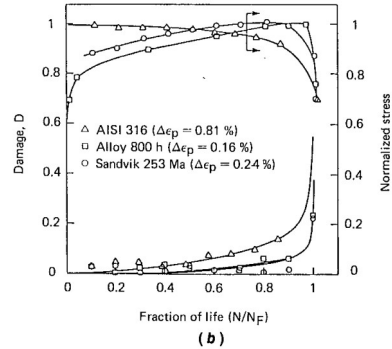
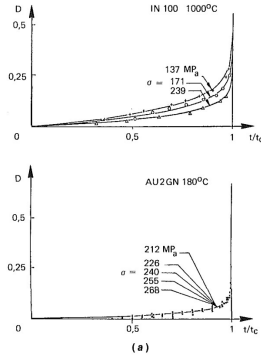


Fig. 5: (a) Creep damage measures—alloys IN 100 at 1000°C and AU2GN at 180°C; (b) damage accumulation curves as measured from the change in elastic response with corresponding cyclic stress response.



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Fatigue damage:** Measures are more complex due to:
 - Surface localization, cyclic hardening/softening (not direct damage).
 - Effective stress concept correlates elastic modulus drop with peak stress evolution (Plumtree & Nilsson, 1986).
 - Good correlation with quantitative microcrack evaluation (Cailletaud & Levillant, 1984; Hua & Socie, 1984; Fig. 5(b)).
- **Damage in composites (graphite/epoxy laminates, Charewicz & Daniel, 1985):**
 - Mechanisms: fiber debonding, matrix microcracking, delamination.
 - Elastic modulus drops on first cycle (partial debonding), then progressively decreases during fatigue with stabilization (Fig. 6).
 - Final delamination leads to rupture.
 - Clear correspondence: modulus decrease, residual strength drop, and remaining life.



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

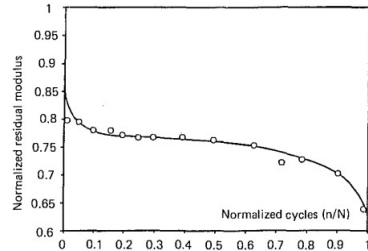
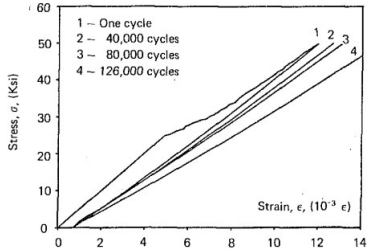


Fig. 6: Fatigue of $[0/904]_s$ graphite/epoxy specimens, $\sigma_{max} = 345$ MPa (50 ksi), $R = 0.1$, from Charewicz and Daniel (1985). (a) stress-strain curves at various stages of the fatigue life; (b) normalized residual elastic modulus.



2.4. Physical Parameters and the Effective Stress Concept

2 Damage Measures and Definitions

- **Active and Passive Damage:**
 - Damage can be either active or passive.
 - When defects, especially microcracks, are closed, they do not affect macroscopic behavior; such damage is considered passive (e.g., under compression).
- **Probabilistic Nature of Damage:**
 - Damage exhibits a probabilistic nature at the microscale.
 - When considering the residual strength of the material, this leads to statistical definitions of damage variables.



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3. Thermodynamic Aspects

Internal State Variables

- **Thermodynamic Aspects:** Based on thermodynamic theory of irreversible processes with internal state variables (Sidoroff, 1975; Germain et al., 1983).
- **Simplified case:** small strain, isotropic hardening, isotropic damage.
- **Extensions:** kinematic hardening (Halphen and Nguyen, 1975); anisotropic damage (Chaboche, 1978; Lemaitre and Chaboche, 1985); finite strain (Rousse-lier, 1980).

Table 1: State Variables

Observable variable	Internal variables	Associated variables
Elastic strain tensor ϵ_e		Stress tensor σ
Temperature T		Entropy S
	Isotropic hardening r	Size increase of yield surface R
	Damage D	Damage strain energy release rate Y



3. Thermodynamic Aspects

Plastic Strain Definitions

- Plastic strain tensor from total strain:

$$\epsilon_p = \epsilon - \epsilon_e$$

- Accumulated plastic strain:

$$p = \left(\frac{2}{3} \dot{\epsilon}_p : \dot{\epsilon}_p \right)^{1/2}$$



3.1. Thermodynamic Potential

Uncoupled Elasticity and Plasticity

- Specific free energy Ψ as thermodynamic potential:

$$\Psi = \Psi_e(\epsilon_e, T, D) + \Psi_p(T, r) \quad (9)$$

- Damaged elastic behavior:

$$\Psi_e = \frac{1}{2\rho}(1 - D)\Lambda : \epsilon_e : \epsilon_e \quad (10)$$

- Stress:

$$\sigma = \rho \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial \epsilon_e} = (1 - D)\Lambda : \epsilon_e \quad \text{or} \quad \sigma = \tilde{\Lambda} : \epsilon_e \quad (11)$$



3.1. Thermodynamic Forces

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- **Thermodynamic forces:** Associated with D and r :

$$Y = \rho \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial D} = -\frac{1}{2} \Lambda : \epsilon_e : \epsilon_e, \quad R = \rho \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial r} \quad (12)$$

- D includes all damaging effects (constant density). In finite strains (Rousselier, 1980), density change can be used as damage variable.
- Complete separability of hardening and damage: Ψ_p independent of D .

- **Elastic strain energy release rate (Chaboche, 1977):**

$$-Y = \frac{W_e}{1 - D} = \frac{1}{2} \frac{dW_e}{dD} \quad \text{at constant } \sigma \text{ and } T \quad (13)$$

- Expression in terms of stress invariants (Lemaitre, 1984):

$$-Y = \frac{\sigma_{eq}^2}{2E(1 - D)^2} \left[\frac{2}{3}(1 + \nu) + 3(1 - 2\nu) \left(\frac{\sigma_H}{\sigma_{eq}} \right)^2 \right] \quad (14)$$



3.1. Thermodynamic Forces

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- **Total dissipated energy separates into:**
 1. Energy stored in the system (hardening).
 2. Heat dissipated energy.
 3. Energy released during damaging $-Y \delta D$, eventually converted into heat.
 - The stored energy equals work above initial yield limit – consequence of simplifying assumptions on isotropic hardening.
 - Additional energies converted to heat can be described using nonlinear kinematic hardening (Lemaitre and Chaboche, 1985) and specific choices for Ψ_p (Fig. 7).



3.1. Thermodynamic Forces

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

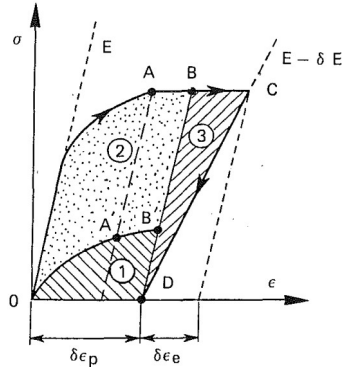


Fig. 7: Schematic of the dissipation during plastic flow and damage growth



3.2. Dissipation

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- **Second principle:** Intrinsic dissipation must be positive:

$$\sigma : \dot{\epsilon}_p - R \dot{r} - Y \dot{D} > 0 \quad (15)$$

- Hardening and damage uncoupled $\Rightarrow$ sufficient condition:

$$-Y \dot{D} > 0 \quad (16)$$

- Since $-Y$ is quadratic, this implies $\dot{D} > 0$.
- Rupture criterion: $-Y = |Y| = Y_c$ (crack initiation) – elastic energy criterion.

- **Rupture stress σ_R in 1D:**

$$Y_c = \frac{\sigma_R^2}{2E(1 - D_c)^2} \Rightarrow D_c = 1 - \frac{\sigma_R}{(2EY_c)^{1/2}} \quad (17)$$

- Experimental range: $0.2 < D_c < 0.8$ – allows neglecting $(1 - D_c)^x$ for $x \gg 1$.



3.2. Dissipation

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- **Dissipation potential ϕ :** Scalar convex function of fluxes $(\dot{\epsilon}_p, \dot{r}, \dot{D}, q)$ or dual variables via Legendre-Fenchel transform (Germain et al., 1983):

$$\phi(\sigma, R, Y; \epsilon_e, T, p, D)$$

- **Constitutive equations for dissipative variables:**

$$\dot{\epsilon}_p = \frac{\partial \phi^*}{\partial \sigma}, \quad \dot{r} = -\frac{\partial \phi^*}{\partial R}, \quad \dot{D} = \frac{\partial \phi^*}{\partial Y} \quad (18)$$

- If ϕ^* convex in $-Y$, damage dissipation (16) automatically positive (Chaboche, 1977).



3.2. Dissipation

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- Time-independent plasticity, isotropic hardening (Lemaître and Chaboche, 1985):

$$f(\sigma, R, D) = \bar{\sigma}_{eq} - R - k < 0, \quad \bar{\sigma}_{eq} = \frac{\sigma_{eq}}{1 - D} \quad (19)$$

- Normality rule (σ' : stress deviator):

$$\dot{\epsilon}_p = \lambda \frac{\partial f}{\partial \sigma} = \frac{3}{2} \frac{\lambda}{1 - D} \frac{\sigma'}{\sigma_{eq}} \quad (20)$$

$$\dot{r} = \lambda \frac{\partial f}{\partial R} = \lambda = \left(\frac{2}{3} \dot{\epsilon}_p : \dot{\epsilon}_p \right)^{1/2} = (1 - D) \dot{p}$$

- Plastic multiplier from consistency $\dot{f} = 0$. For $D = 0$, p = accumulated plastic strain.
- Normality is sufficient, not necessary (Onat, 1985). Sometimes too restrictive (e.g., creep). Only required: $\dot{D} > 0$ (since $-Y > 0$).



3.2. Dissipation

3 Thermodynamic Aspects

- **Generalization to large strains with modifications (Rousselier, 1980):**
 - First damage parameter: density change – affects elastic behavior.
 - Second parameter: explicit dependency of plastic potential on hydrostatic stress – generalizes Rice & Tracey (1969) formula for spherical void growth under high triaxiality.



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Damage Growth, Crack Initiation, and Crack Growth

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Damage variables** specific to different processes:
 - Creep, fatigue (high/low cycle), ductile damage, brittle damage.
- **Damage growth equations** derived from a dissipative potential (thermodynamics).
- **Two main application domains:**
 1. **Life prediction:** Damage growth and crack initiation in structures (creep, fatigue, creep-fatigue).
 2. **Macroscopic crack growth:** Improve “local approaches to fracture” beyond classical Fracture Mechanics.
- **Practical outcome:** Better prediction of material deterioration and residual life.



4.1. Creep Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Creep damage evolution:** Under pure tensile stress,

$$dD = \left(\frac{\sigma}{A}\right)^r (1 - D)^{-k} dt \quad (21)$$

- Damage variable D : 0 (undamaged) to 1 (rupture).
- Integration under constant stress gives rupture time:

$$t_c = \frac{1}{k+1} \left(\frac{\sigma}{A}\right)^{-r} \quad (22)$$

- Damage evolution with time:

$$D = 1 - \left(\frac{t}{t_c}\right)^{1/(k+1)} \quad (23)$$



4.1. Creep Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Effective stress concept** (Chaboche): Norton's secondary creep law extended:

$$\dot{\epsilon}_p = \left[\frac{\sigma}{K(1-D)} \right]^n \quad (24)$$

- Damage depends on stress invariants:
 - Octahedral shear stress $J_2(\sigma)$ (shear effects)
 - Hydrostatic stress $J_1(\sigma)$ (cavity growth)
 - Maximum principal stress $J_0(\sigma) = \sigma_1$ (microcrack opening)(Fig. 8)
- **Hayhurst equivalent stress** (linear form):

$$\chi(\sigma) = \alpha J_0(\sigma) + \beta J_1(\sigma) + (1 - \alpha - \beta) J_2(\sigma) \quad (25)$$

- Multiaxial time to failure:

$$t_c = \frac{1}{k+1} \left(\frac{\chi(\sigma)}{A} \right)^{-r} \quad (26)$$



4.1. Creep Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- Alternative product form (physical interpretation):

$$\chi(\sigma) = [J_0(\sigma)]^\alpha [J_2(\sigma)]^{1-\alpha} \quad (27)$$

- Alternative damage growth equation using creep strain (Contesti, 1986):

$$dD = A [J_0(\sigma)]^\alpha \epsilon_{eq}^\beta d\epsilon_{eq} \quad (28)$$

- One-to-one mapping between strain-based and time-based formulations (Eqs. (21) and (24)):

$$D \longrightarrow \left[1 - (1 - D)^{k-n+1}\right]^{\beta+1} \quad (29)$$

- **Note:** Pure compression yields no damage under product form – not fully accurate for polycrystalline metals (two-level creep tests, Policella et al., 1982).



4.1. Creep Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

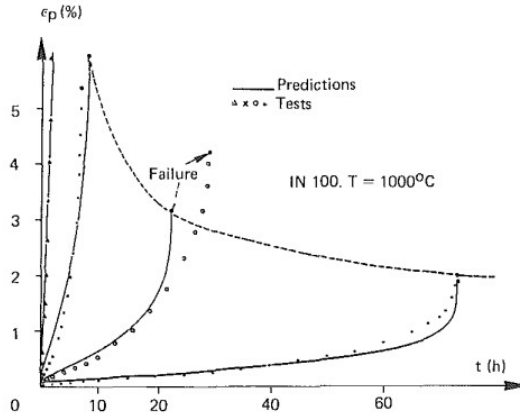


Fig. 8: Calculated and measured creep curves on superalloy IN 100. Prediction of creep ductility.



4.2. Fatigue Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- Key aspects of fatigue damage:
 - Microinitiation and micropropagation stages.
 - Nonlinear cumulative effects (two-level tests, block-program loading).
 - Decrease of fatigue limit after prior damage.
 - Mean-stress effects on S–N curves and fatigue limit.
- General damage accumulation model (Chaboche, 1974):

$$dD = D^{\alpha(\sigma_M, \bar{\sigma})} \left[\frac{\sigma_M - \bar{\sigma}}{M(\bar{\sigma})} \right]^{\beta} dN \quad (30)$$

where σ_M = maximum stress, $\bar{\sigma}$ = mean stress.

- Two-level test integration gives nonlinear interaction:

$$\frac{N_2}{N_{F_2}} = 1 - \left(\frac{N_1}{N_{F_1}} \right)^{\frac{1-\alpha_2}{1-\alpha_1}} \quad (31)$$

- Function $M(\bar{\sigma})$ derived from linear dependency between $\bar{\sigma}$ and fatigue limit.



4.2. Fatigue Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Equivalence of damage definitions:**
 - Effective stress concept (CDM).
 - Remaining life concept (Eq. (30) based).
 - Physical microcrack measurements (Cailletaud & Levaillant, 1984; Socie et al., 1983).
- **Low-Cycle Fatigue:** Life parametrized by plastic (or total) strain range.

One-to-one relation between σ_M and $\Delta\varepsilon_p$ (cyclic curve).

Mean-stress influence naturally included in Eq. (30).

- **Multiaxial generalization:**
 - Two parameters needed: equivalent shear-stress amplitude, and mean/maximum hydrostatic stress.
 - Near fatigue limit: independence of mean shear stress and hydrostatic range (Dang Van, 1973).
 - Nonproportional loading conditions require further study.



4.3. Creep-Fatigue Interaction

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Approach (Chaboche, 1980):** Direct summation of creep and fatigue damage rates.

$$dD = f_c(\sigma, D) dt + f_F(\sigma_M, \bar{\sigma}, D) dN \quad (32)$$

- **Functions:**
 - f_c : from creep model (e.g., Kachanov-Rabotnov).
 - f_F : from fatigue model (e.g., nonlinear cumulative).
- **Prediction:** Integrate numerically for low-frequency or hold-time conditions.
- **Critical Clarification:**
 - Physical defects (cavities, microcracks) are **not** added.
 - Only **mechanical effects** added via effective stress concept.



4.4. Oxidation-Fatigue-Creep Interactions

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **High-Temperature Effect:** Oxidation superimposes on creep and fatigue.
- **Oxidation Enhances:**
 - **Nucleation:** Surface cracks, grain boundary oxidation, internal voids.
 - **Growth:** Crack tip deterioration, void growth from particles.
- **Modeling Integration:**
 - Explicit in fatigue models (initiation + propagation phases).
 - Implicit (conceptual) in creep damage equations.



4.5. Ductile Plastic Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- **Ductile damage:** initiation and growth of cavities due to large deformations.
- Dissipative potential in time-independent plasticity (Lemaitre & Chaboche, 1985):

$$\phi^* = \bar{\sigma}_{eq} - R - k + \frac{S}{2} \frac{1}{1-D} \left(-\frac{Y}{S} \right)^2 \quad (33)$$

- **Constitutive equations:**

$$\dot{\epsilon}_p = \lambda \frac{\partial \phi}{\partial \sigma}, \quad \dot{r} = -\lambda \frac{\partial \phi^*}{\partial R} = \dot{p}(1-D) \quad (34)$$

$$\dot{D} = -\lambda \frac{\partial \phi^*}{\partial Y} = -\frac{Y}{S} \dot{p} \quad (35)$$

- **Hardening law:** Using the relation (14),

$$\sigma_{eq} = R + k + K \dot{p}^{1/M} \quad (36)$$



4.5. Ductile Plastic Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

- Combining (14)–(16) gives the differential equation (Lemaitre, 1985):

$$\dot{D} = \frac{K^2}{2ES} \left[\frac{2}{3}(1 + \nu) + 3(1 - 2\nu) \left(\frac{\sigma_H}{\sigma_{eq}} \right)^2 \right] p^{2/M} \dot{p} \quad (37)$$

- For radial loading (constant triaxiality ratio σ_H/σ_{eq}):

- Damage threshold: $p < p_D \Rightarrow D = 0$

- Rupture strain: $p = p_R \Rightarrow D = D_c$

- Integrated form (neglecting elastic strain):

$$D = \frac{D_c}{\epsilon_R - \epsilon_D} \left\{ p \left[\frac{2}{3}(1 + \nu) + 3(1 - 2\nu) \left(\frac{\sigma_H}{\sigma_{eq}} \right)^2 \right] - \epsilon_D \right\} \quad (38)$$

- Identification from experiments: ϵ_D , ϵ_R , D_c (Poisson's ratio ν known).
- Model predicts influence of triaxiality on strain to failure (Fig. 9).
- Applicable to fracture limits in metal forming (Lemaitre, 1984).



4.5. Ductile Plastic Damage

4 Damage Growth Equations

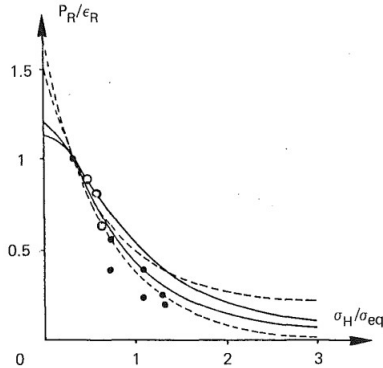


Fig. 9: Influence of triaxiality on fracture strain. ●● : A508 steel; ○○ : H steel; ===== : domain covered by McClintock/Rice-Tracey models; ===== : domain covered by the present model.



4.6. Brittle Damage and Elastic Behavior

4 Damage Growth Equations

- Simple damage growth law for pure tension (Lemaitre & Chaboche, 1985):

$$dD = \begin{cases} \left(\frac{\epsilon}{\epsilon_0}\right)^s d\epsilon & \text{if } \epsilon = \xi, d\epsilon = d\xi > 0 \\ 0 & \text{if } \epsilon < \xi \text{ or } d\epsilon < 0 \end{cases} \quad (39)$$

- Integration with elastic behavior ($\sigma = E(1 - D)\epsilon$) gives:

$$D = \left(\frac{\epsilon}{\epsilon_R}\right)^{s+1}, \quad \sigma = E\epsilon \left[1 - \left(\frac{\epsilon}{\epsilon_R}\right)^{s+1}\right] \quad (40)$$

where ϵ_R = rupture strain ($D = 1$).



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5.1. Prediction of Crack Initiation

5 Life Prediction in Structures

- **Two independent aspects for life calculations at high temperature:**
 - Macrocrack initiation – essential for design methodologies.
 - Crack propagation – “Damage Tolerance” concept for design and maintenance.
- **Classical approach:**
 - Compute stress-strain state at each point.
 - Predict crack initiation from stress/strain fields.
- **Problem:** fatigue damage nucleation/growth from initial stress concentrations.
Macroscopic gradients vs. microlevel.



5.1. Prediction of Crack Initiation

5 Life Prediction in Structures

- **Overcoming strategies:**
 - Macro- and micro-plasticity inducing stress redistribution.
 - Introduce a critical distance (material dependent).
- **Future approaches:**
 - Coupling between material deterioration and stress-strain behavior (Marquis et al., 1981).
 - No stabilized cycle – model follows physical processes throughout the whole life (thousands of cycles).
 - Currently impractical for real structures under fatigue or HT-LCF with hold periods, but progress in computer speed and “cycle jump” algorithms (Savalle & Culié, 1978) may enable future applications.
- **Creep situation:** Coupling already applied (Marquis et al., 1981; Hayhurst, 1983), improving life predictions.



5.2 Crack Propagation by Fracture Mechanics Concepts

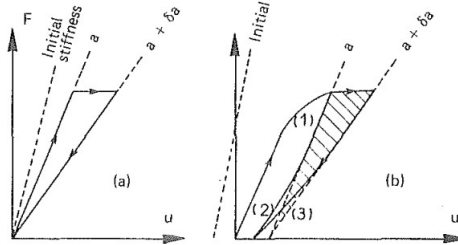
5 Life Prediction in Structures

- **Classical approach:**
 - Predict crack growth and fracture in structural components is based on Fracture Mechanics concepts.
 - Global parameters like The stress intensity factor K , the elastic strain energy release rate G , the contour integral J ,
 - Linear Elastic Fracture Mechanics constitutes a practical tool to predict crack growth.
 -
- **Three developments for high temperature problems:**
 - Creep-Fatigue Interaction for Brittle Materials,
 - Application Under Thermal Fatigue,
 - Application to Ductile Materials (Fig. 10).



5.2 Crack Propagation by Fracture Mechanics Concepts

5 Life Prediction in Structures



- (1) $\rightarrow$ Plastic flow during loading.
- (2) $\rightarrow$ Actual unloading before and after crack growth.
- (3) $\rightarrow$ Fictitious elastic unloading.

Fig. 10: Schematics of the elastic energy release rate: (a) elastic brittle solid; (b) elasto-plastic brittle solid.



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

- **Limitations of global Fracture Mechanics concepts:**
 - Complex situations: short cracks, history effects (overloads, warm-prestress), ductile fracture, creep crack growth.
 - Even when correlations exist, alternative methods are needed.
- **Local approaches (Janson & Hult, 1977):**
 - Consider actual behavior at crack tip.
 - Calculate local stress/strain fields and deterioration.
 - Local failure criterion predicts crack increment and instability.
- **Two levels of local approach:**
 1. Numerical methods with discrete crack increments (node release).
 2. Continuum Damage Mechanics (CDM) with progressive deterioration.



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

Level 1: Discrete Crack Increments

- **Technique:** Node release to produce crack growth when critical value of a physical quantity is reached at a critical distance ahead of the crack tip (Newman, 1974; Hinnerirhs, 1980; Anquez, 1983; Devaux & Mottet, 1984).
- **Physical quantity can be:**
 - Equivalent stress or strain.
 - Energy.
 - Local damage measure.
- **Mesh dependence:** Prediction depends on chosen mesh size (Newman, 1974). Local mesh size fixed via statistical considerations (Rousselier, 1986; Mudry, 1986).
- **Simplified approaches:** Use analytical stress-strain fields near crack tip (Maas & Pineau, 1985).



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

Level 2: Continuum Damage Mechanics

- **Concept:** Progressive deterioration with stiffness reduction. Crack = locus of material points with no rigidity (damage $\rightarrow$ critical value; Fig. 11).
- **Advantage:** No need for critical distance or node release. Stress redistribution due to viscoplasticity and strength decrease; stresses in plastic zone decrease continuously as damage increases approaching crack tip.
- **Pioneering work:** Hayhurst et al. (1975) in creep domain.
- **Current developments in:**
 - Ductile fracture (Rousselier et al., 1985; Rousselier, 1986).
 - Creep crack growth (Saanouni et al., 1985; Hayhurst, 1985).
 - Fatigue (Ben Allal et al., 1984).
 - Concrete rupture (Mazars, 1985).



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

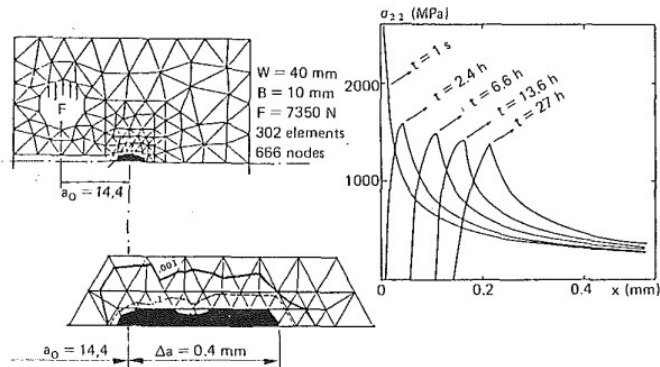


Fig. 11: Creep crack growth prediction by a local approach for a CT specimen in INCO 718 at 600 C.



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

- **Theoretical insight:** CDM with discontinuous damage growth law (sudden 0 to 1) solves Rice's paradox – consistency of energy dissipated at crack tip. Simplified damage laws allow analytical solutions (Bui & Ehrlacher, 1985; Bui et al., 1986).
- **Attractiveness:** Implement more physical rupture criteria and damage processes at crack tip.
- **Laboratory success:** Good results; beginning industrial application, especially for cleavage and ductile fracture (Devaux et al., 1986).



5.3. Local Approaches to Fracture

5 Life Prediction in Structures

Remaining Problems

- **Computational cost:** However, difference not large if inelastic analysis already required for Fracture Mechanics. Simplified procedures (analytical fields) could offer intermediate practical way.
- **Mesh dependence:** Common feature of various local approaches. Crack width, growth rate, and failure load depend on chosen mesh size – even with full elastic-plastic-damage coupling (Saanouni et al., 1985).
- **Practical solution:** Local mesh size fixed per application after calibration.



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Conclusion

6 Conclusion

- **General concepts reviewed:** Measures and definitions of damage variables, incorporation into thermodynamic framework.
- **Main feature of CDM:** Coupling effects between damaging processes and stress-strain behavior.
- **Damage growth equations:** Specified and particularized to describe:
 - Creep and fatigue processes.
 - Ductile damage and brittle damage.



Conclusion

6 Conclusion

- **Practical damage rate equations presented** (uniaxial and multiaxial) for:
 - Creep, fatigue, creep-fatigue interaction.
 - Ductile plastic damage of metals.
 - Brittle damage (especially concrete).
- **Applications:** Predict crack initiation in structural components; CDM enables additional possibilities in local approaches to fracture.
- **Rational approach:** Extension of Continuum Mechanics – connects microstructure measurements to mechanical parameters.
- **Wide applicability:** Various loading conditions, materials, physical processes.
- **Life predictions:** Accounts for coupling between deterioration and mechanical behavior.
- **Future:** Will be developed further and extensively used as a complementary tool between Continuum Mechanics and Fracture Mechanics.



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Q&A

Thank you for listening!
Your feedback will be highly appreciated!